

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 6

♦ A Q 8

♣ K Q J 7 5

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ 8 3



♠ J 10 2

♥ 9 8 3

♦ J 10 4

♣ 9 6 4 2

♠ K 6

♥ A K J 10 5 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ A 10

West

1 ♣

Pass

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by South

over-ruff. Otherwise you ruff with a small trump.

North

Pass

1 ♠

4♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

Dbl

3♥

North realizes that to make a takeout double, then jump in your own suit you must have a very good hand. So he bids the game. South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣K, which you take with the ♣A.

You have four losers. If you are thinking about leading toward your ♦K you are delusionary. West has the ♦A and you know it. Your best hope is to end-play West with the ♣10 and force him to break the ♦s.

Play one round of trumps with the ♥A. You can't play any more because you will need an entry to dummy for the elimination.

Next play ♠K, ♠A and ruff a ♠ high.

Lead a ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. West shows out. Play dummy's last ♠. East is now void, so if he ruffs you

Now throw West in (you hope!) with the ♣10.

Fortunately West has to take the ♣10. Since he has nothing left but ♣s and ♦s he must lead one or the other. A ♦ lead will give you a trick with your ♦K and a ♣ lead will allow you to ruff in dummy (East still has a ♣) and discard a ♦ from your hand.

Some problems are tougher than others, this being a tough one.

It was not a complete elimination since East still had a trump when you threw West in. However, it worked because West was out of both ♠s and ♥s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K J 9 5
♦ Q J 10 4
♣ Q 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 7 5

♥ 7

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ K 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8
♥ Q 10 8 4 2
♦ A 9 5 2
♣ A J 8

♠ A K Q 6 3 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ 7

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South
a winner. But it will still prove to be useful.

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Unless West is real beginner East will hold the ♦ A so you should not try the ♦ K on this trick. And when West continues with the ♦ J you should again duck in dummy, ruffing with an honor in your hand.

The contract is in danger if East holds the ♣ A because you would have three ♣ losers to go with the ♦ already lost. One really good possibility is that East now has the lone ♦ A and you can set up dummy's ♦ K with a ruff.

So play a small ♠ to dummy's ♠ 9, (pulling the two outstanding trumps), and ruff another ♦ with an honor, hoping the ♦ A drops.

Too bad, the ♦ A did not fall so dummy's ♦ K is not

Play the ♥ A, then ruff a ♥ in dummy. Play a trump to your ♠ A and ruff your last ♥.

You are in dummy, just where you want to be. Play the ♦ K, and when East plays the ♦ A don't ruff but instead discard a ♣ from your hand. You knew all along that he held the ♦ A.

[showcards N:SJ,CK,C5,C3 S:S6,S3,C7,C6]

East is end-played, forced to either break the ♣ s and give you a ♣ trick, or give you a ruff-sluff.

This was the toughest hand so far and the end-play depended upon your correct reading that East must hold the ♦ A.

It also depended upon the defenders not switching to ♣ s at the second trick. If West had decided to switch to the ♣ Q you would have had no chance at all.